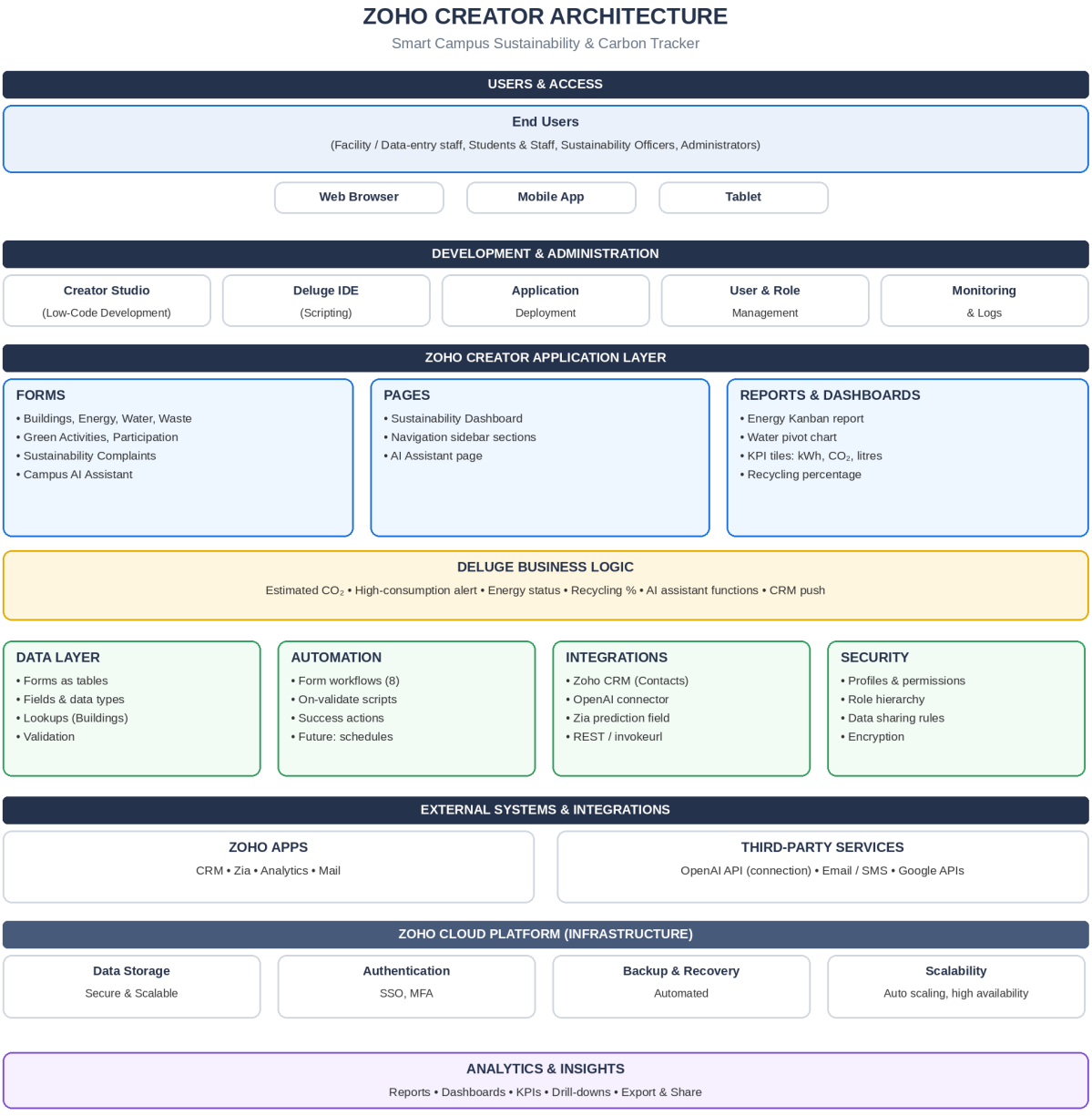
Setting up a Zoho Creator account and exploring the platform architecture and interface

Architecture Diagram

Smart Campus Sustainability & Carbon Tracker



ARCHITECTURE FLOW

→ Staff and students use the application through web or mobile

→ Energy, water, waste and complaint data is captured in forms and stored

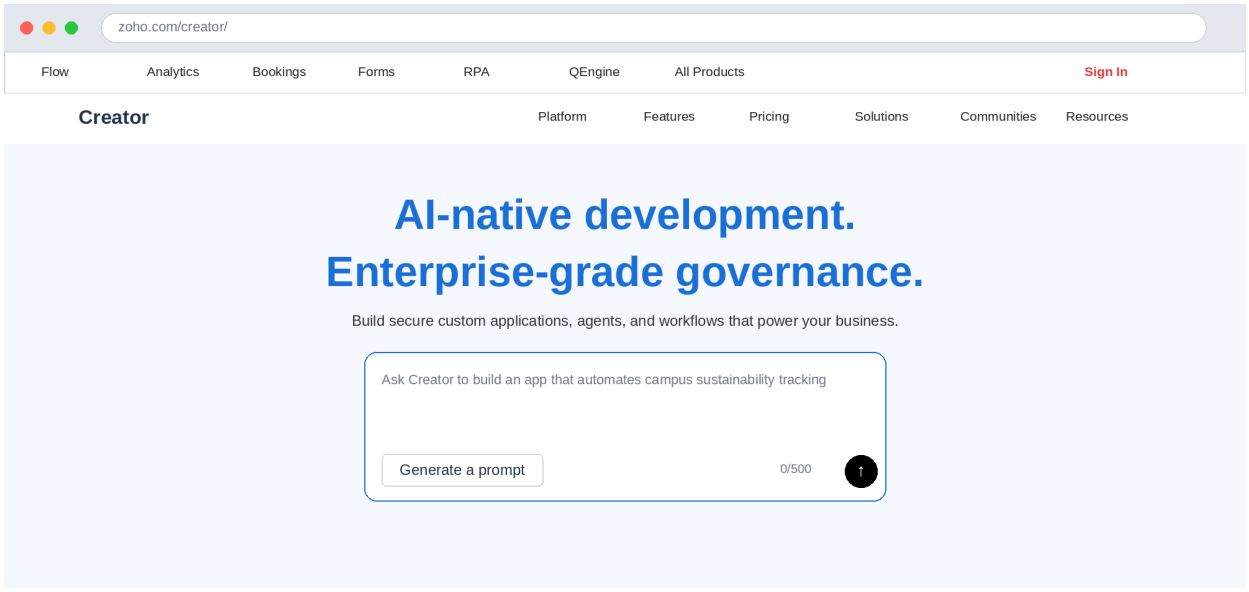
→ Deluge applies business logic (CO_2, status, alerts, recycling %)

→ Workflows push complaints to Zoho CRM and answer AI-assistant questions

→ Data is managed on the Zoho cloud under roles and sharing rules

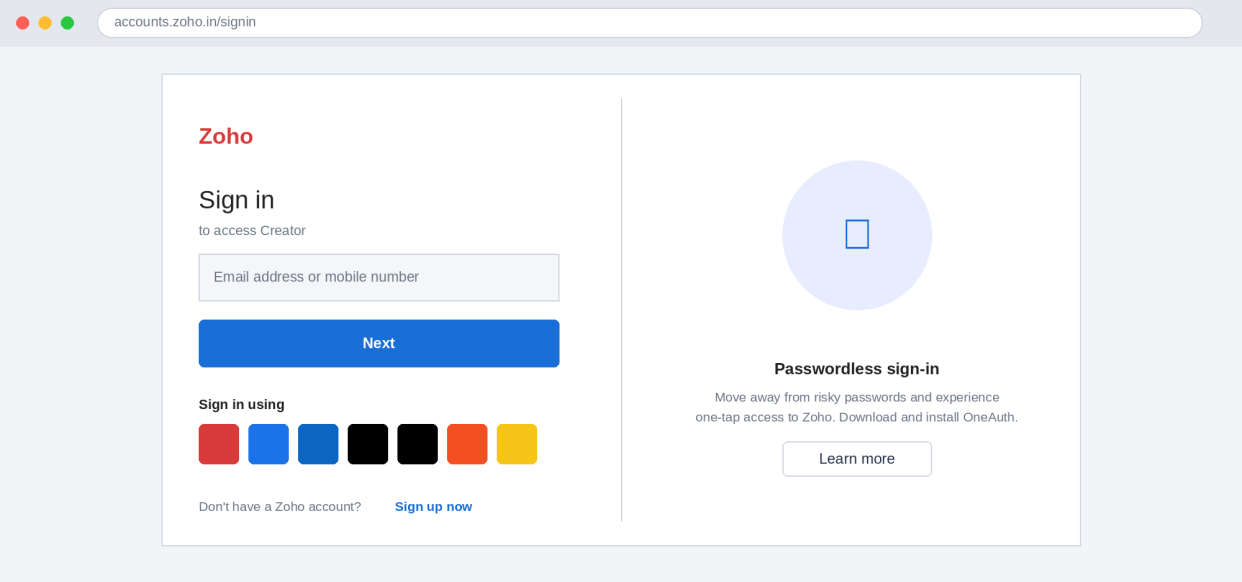
→ Insights are generated through reports and the Sustainability Dashboard

1.Zoho Creator AI Application Landing Page



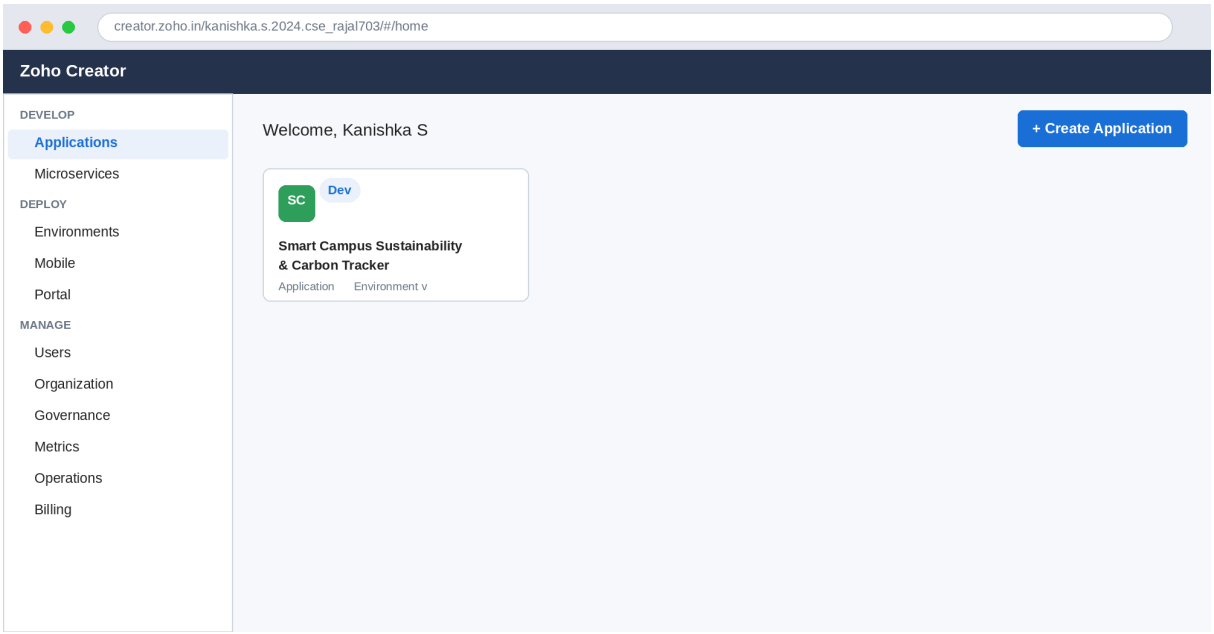
The Zoho Creator landing page presents the platform as AI-native development with enterprise-grade governance. A prompt box lets users describe the app they need in plain language, such as an app that tracks campus energy, water and waste, while the top menu gives access to Platform, Features, Pricing, Solutions and Sign In.

2.Zoho Creator Sign In/Authentication Pool



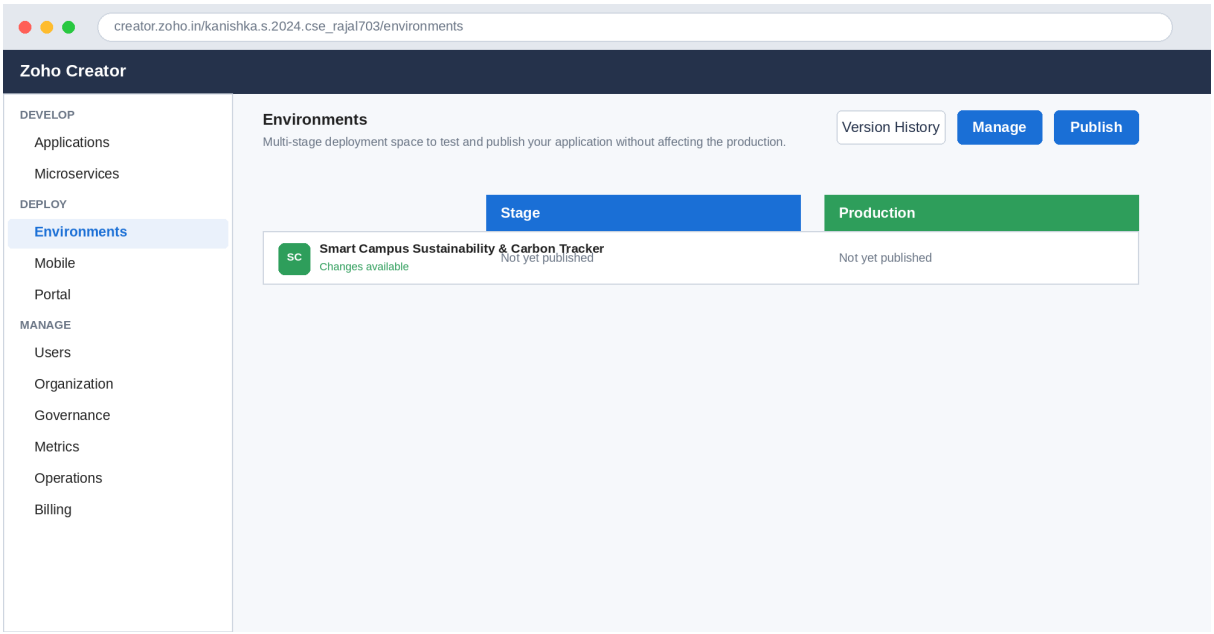
The sign-in page asks for an email address or mobile number and also offers sign-in through Google, Facebook, LinkedIn, X, Apple and Microsoft. It promotes passwordless sign-in through OneAuth, which keeps access to the workspace secure and effortless. New users can create an account with the Sign up now link.

3.Zoho Creator User Dashboard



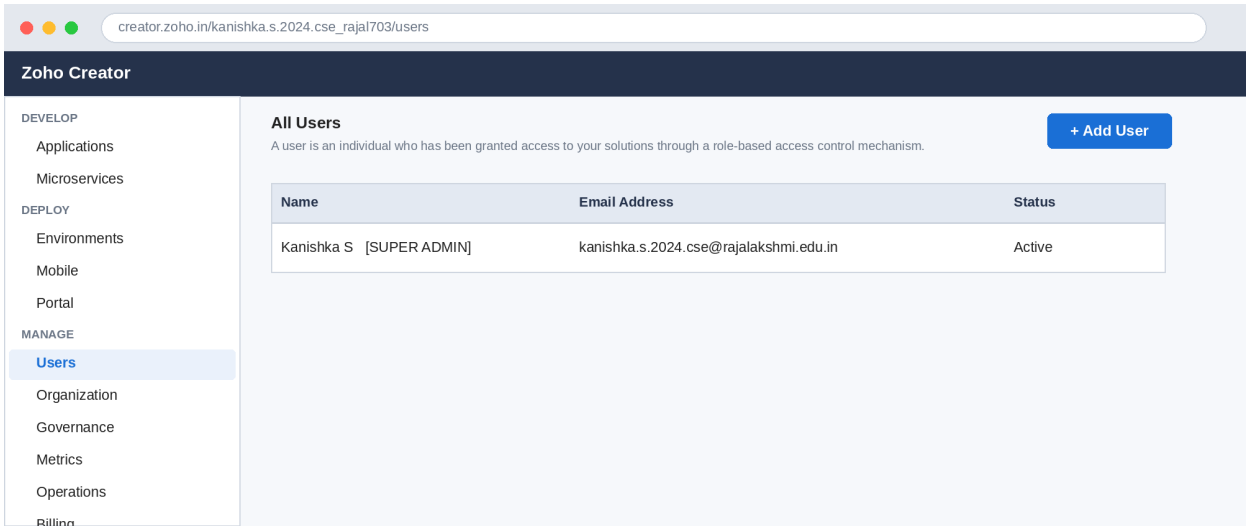
Once signed in, the dashboard greets Kanishka S and lists the applications in the workspace, including Smart Campus Sustainability & Carbon Tracker. The sidebar organizes everything under Develop, Deploy and Manage, which keeps navigation simple.

4.Multistage Environment Dashboard



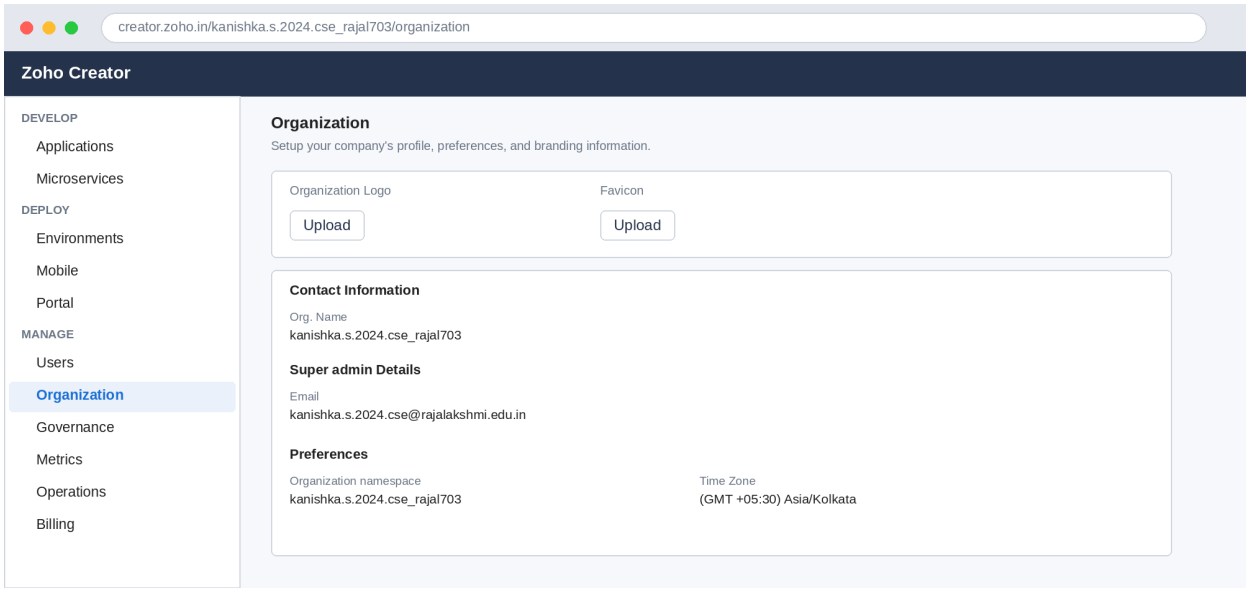
The “Environments” page is a multi-stage deployment space for testing and publishing applications without affecting production. The Smart Campus application shows “Changes available” and is marked “Not yet published” in the Stage and Production columns. Version History, Manage and Publish options are provided at the top.

5.User Management and Role Based Access



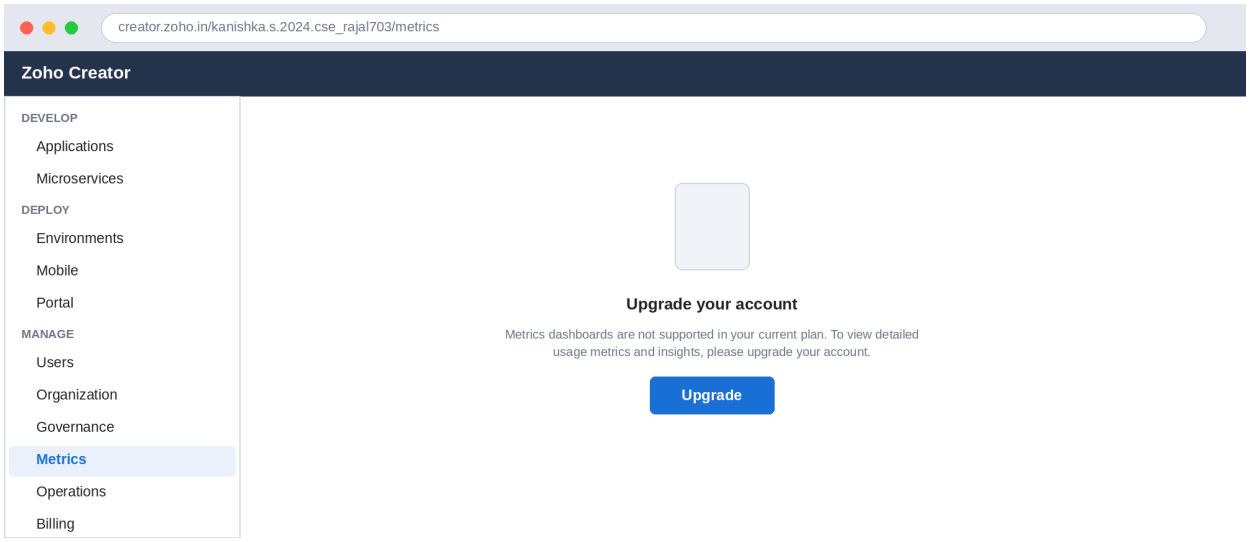
The “Users” section lists everyone who has been granted access through role-based access control. Kanishka S appears as the Super Admin with an active status. Further users, such as data entry staff, facility coordinators and sustainability officers, can be added with the Add User button and given role-based access.

6.Organization Settings and Profile Setup



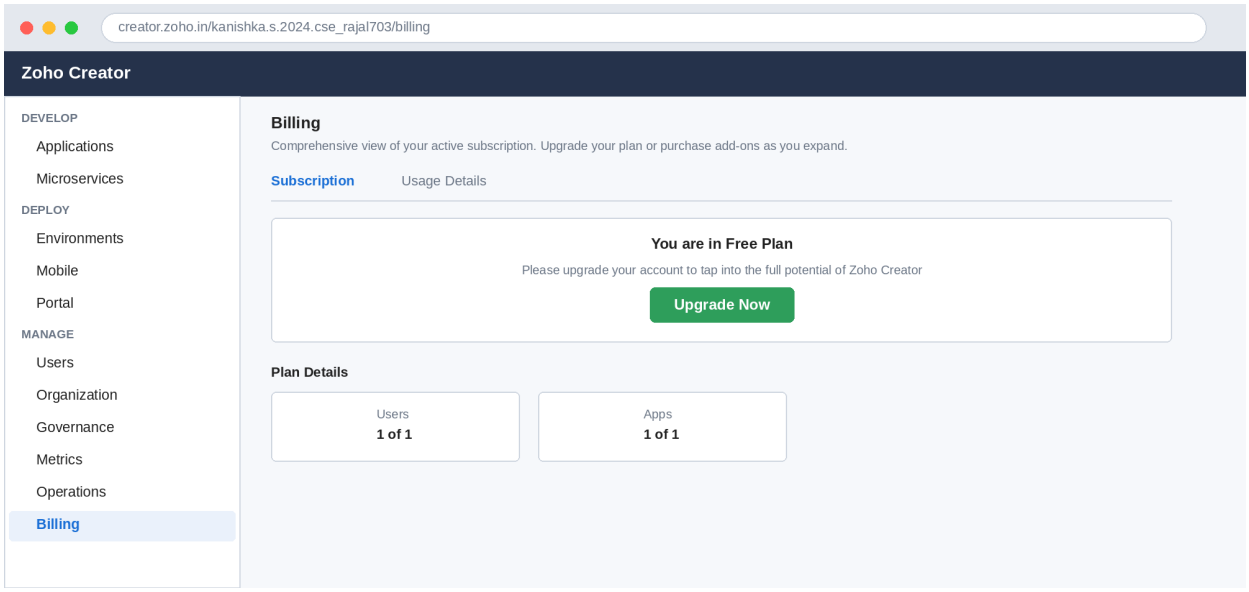
In the “Organization” tab, users can upload an organization logo and favicon and view contact information, super admin details and preferences. The page shows the organization name and namespace and the time zone, (GMT +05:30) Asia/Kolkata. This gives the workspace its identity while keeping administrative details together.

7.Metrics and Application Analysis Dashboard



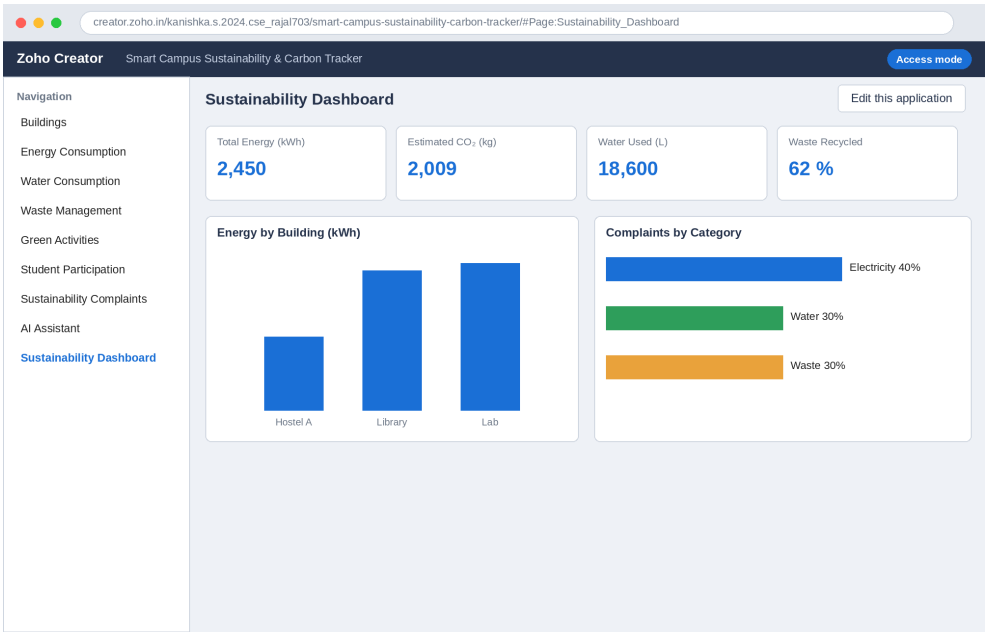
The “Metrics” page is meant to give detailed usage metrics and insights into application activity. On the current plan it shows an “Upgrade your account” message, because metrics dashboards are not supported in the plan used. An Upgrade button is provided.

8.Billing and Subscription Management



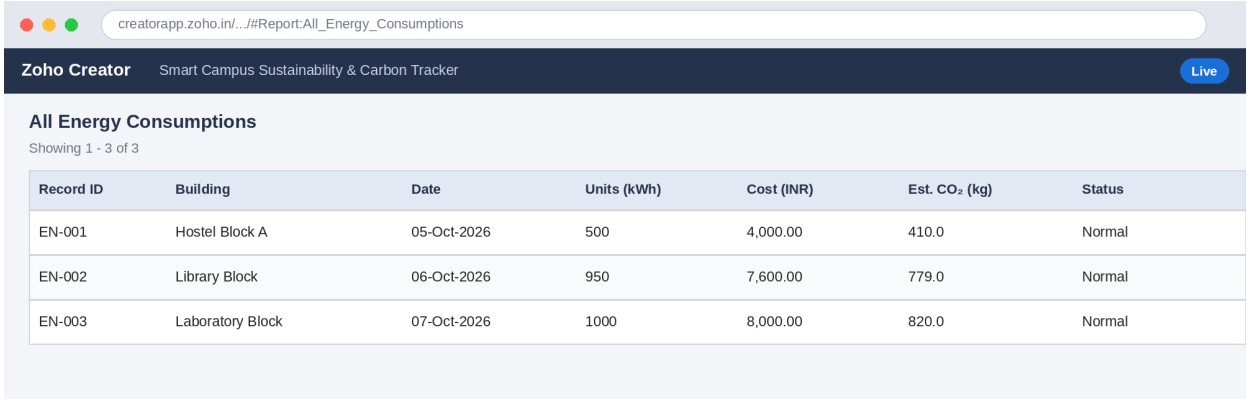
The “Billing” page shows the active subscription. The account is on the Free Plan, with an Upgrade Now option to unlock the full potential of Zoho Creator. The Plan Details section shows usage against the plan limits (Users 1 of 1 and Apps 1 of 1), so the account stays transparent and easy to manage.

9.Live Custom Application Home Dashboard



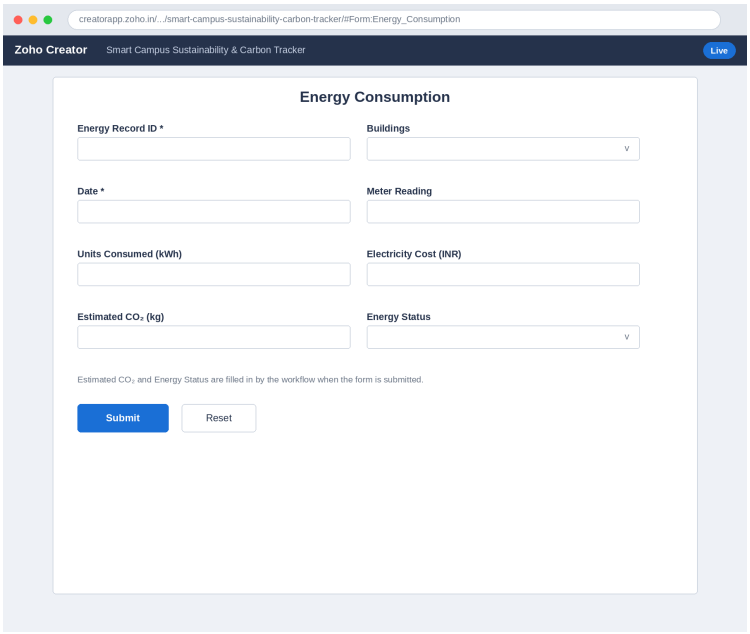
Opening an application in access mode shows its home dashboard. This is the Sustainability Dashboard of the Smart Campus Sustainability & Carbon Tracker, which summarizes the data with tiles (Total Energy, Estimated CO_2, Water Used and Waste Recycled), a column chart of energy by building and a bar chart of complaints by category, with the navigation menu on the left.

10.Detailed Data Report View



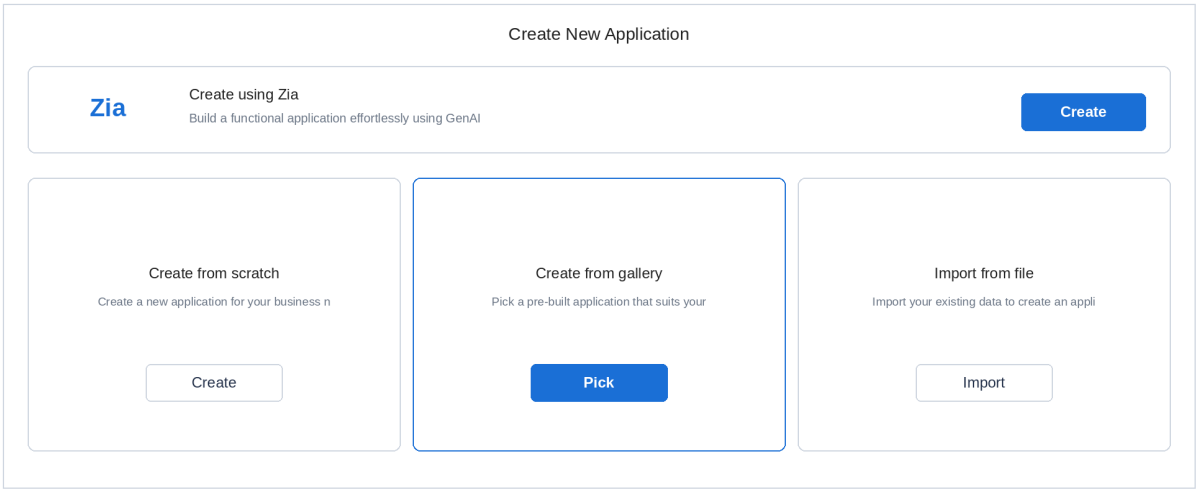
The “All Energy Consumptions” page is a report that lists the records in detail, with columns such as record ID, building, date, units consumed, electricity cost, estimated CO_2 and energy status. The footer shows “Showing 1 - 3 of 3” records.

11.Adding a New Record



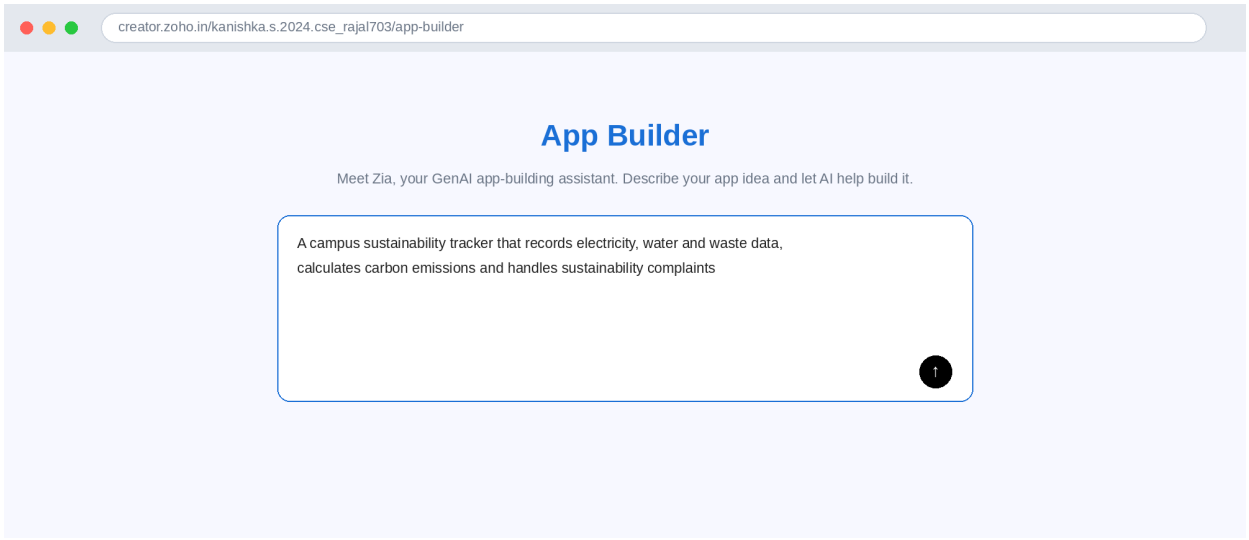
The Energy Consumption menu item opens the form used to add new records to the application. The Estimated CO_2 and Energy Status fields are left for the workflow to fill in when the form is submitted. This shows how the form menu and the application workflows are linked.

12.Create New Application Options



The “Create New Application” screen offers four ways to start: build an application using Zia (GenAI), create one from scratch, pick a pre-built application from the gallery, or import an existing file. It is flexible and suits both beginners and experienced developers.

13.Gen AI App Builder Prompt Screen



The “App Builder” page introduces Zoho’s GenAI assistant Zia and invites users to describe their app idea, for example a campus sustainability tracker for energy, water, waste and complaints, so that AI can help build it. It is minimalistic and emphasizes ease and creativity.

Note: all figures in this record are illustrative views of the Zoho Creator screens and data used in the experiment.